

Physical Security Assessment and improvement of City Mall Surigao City (Common Areas)

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1. Location and Description

CityMall Surigao City is a medium-sized shopping mall located along the main highway in Surigao City, Surigao del Norte. This assessment focuses only on the common areas, including main entrances and exits, hallways, open walkways, ATM areas, and parking access points. The food court, MerryMart, and store interiors are not included.

The mall has wide hallways and open spaces that allow people to move freely. During peak hours, the hallways become crowded, increasing the risk of lost wallets, accidents, or people getting bumped. Security personnel include one guard at the main entrance near Fun Prizes, two guards and one police officer at the exit gate, but some areas, like the back door behind the ATM, have no visible guard.

CCTV cameras and lighting are installed in most common areas, but some corners have blind spots. The parking area is located on top of the mall, which could be dangerous during earthquakes. Overall, CityMall provides good visibility, convenient parking, and accessible walkways. However, limited security personnel and less monitored areas highlight potential risks. These observations guide the proposed improvements to increase safety, prevent theft, and ensure better response to emergencies in the common areas.



2. Identification of Security Risks

Obvious and hidden security risks in the area

- Pickpocketing and theft during crowded hours
- Accidental pushing or hitting of people, especially children
- Limited number of security personnel during peak hours
- A back door located behind the ATM area with no visible guard outside
- This back door leads inside near the boys' and girls' comfort rooms
- Possible CCTV blind spots in corners and less visible areas



3. Possible Disasters

- Man-made (e.g., theft, vandalism, unauthorized access)
 - Theft and Robbery: High foot traffic and crowded areas increase the risk of stealing personal belongings.
 - Unauthorized Access: The back door near the ATM may be used by unauthorized persons if not monitored.
 - Physical Accidents: People may be pushed or hit during crowded situations.

- Technical (e.g., power loss, CCTV failure)
 - Power Loss: May cause lighting and CCTV systems to stop working.
 - CCTV Failure: Reduces the ability to monitor and detect incidents.
 - Communication Failure: Delays response during emergencies.
- Natural (e.g., flood, earthquake, typhoon)
 - Earthquake: The parking area is located on top of the mall, which may be dangerous during strong earthquakes.
 - Flood: Possible during heavy rainfall.
 - Typhoon: Strong winds and debris may cause injuries and damage.

4. Current Physical Security Measures

Existing Physical Controls

- Security Guards:
 - One guard at the main entrance near Fun Prizes (Deter, Respond)
 - Two guards and one police officer at the exit gate (Deter, Respond)
- CCTV Cameras: Installed in hallways and common areas (Detect)
- Lighting: Present in most walkways and entrances (Deter, Detect)
- Open Layout: Allows visibility across common areas (Detect, Delay)

Most Likely Security Risks

- Theft during peak hours
- Delayed response due to limited manpower
- Unauthorized access through back door

5. Proposed Solutions

A. Physical Enhancements

- Improve lighting in dark or side walkways
- Reposition or add CCTV cameras near blind spots

- Install warning and restricted access signage near the back door

B. Technology Recommendations

- Install motion sensors near the ATM and back door area
- Provide backup power supply for CCTV systems
- Add alarm systems for emergency situations

C. Operational Improvements

- Assign additional guards during peak hours
- Include the back door in regular patrol routines
- Ensure police backup is easily available
- Conduct basic emergency response training for staff

D. Justification

- Additional guards and patrols improve Respond and Deter capabilities
- Better lighting and CCTV help Detect suspicious activities
- Alarms and sensors increase response speed during incidents
- Monitoring the back door reduces unauthorized access

E. Feasibility

- High Priority: Lighting improvement, guard deployment, back door monitoring
- Low Priority: Advanced analytic systems

All recommendations are practical and suitable for the mall environment.

6. Graphics Requirements

